

WHISP RISK ASSESSMENT

How deforestation risk is classified and what each severity level means

Low Risk

High Risk

More Info Needed

BASIS OF RISK ASSESSMENT

WHISP (What Is in that Plot) does not rely on a single map. Each global map dataset uses different definitions and classification methods, so no single source can provide a complete picture of a plot. WHISP therefore applies a Convergence of Evidence approach.

1

Tree and Forest Cover

At the end of 2020

2

Commodities

Crop or agricultural use in 2020

3

Disturbances before 2021

Deforestation through Dec 2020

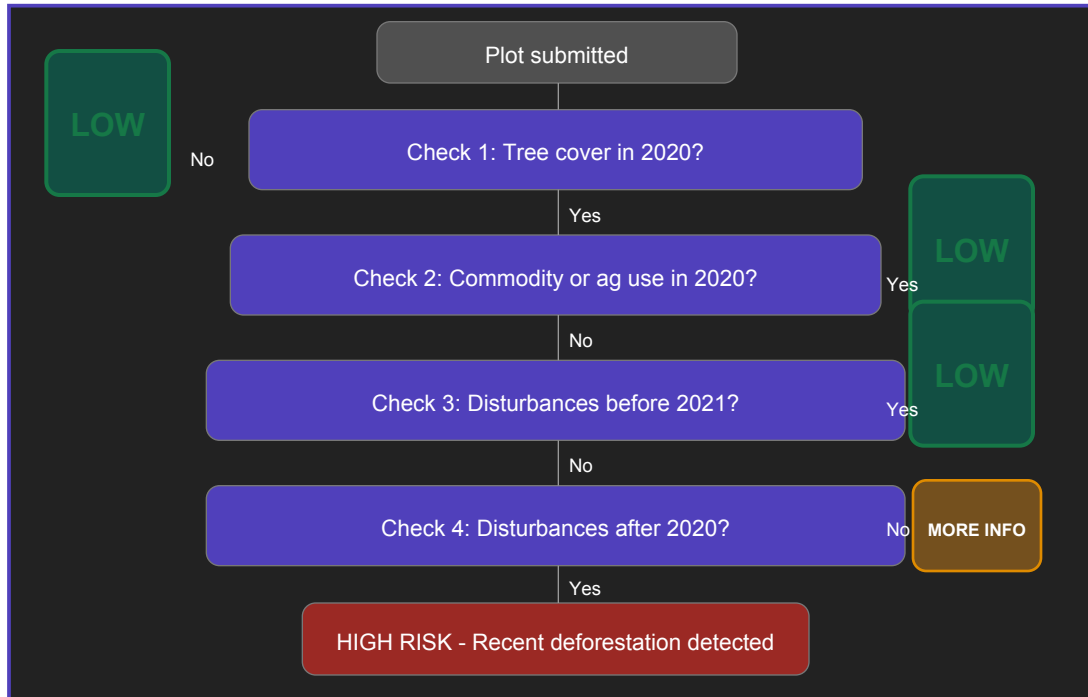
4

Disturbances after 2020

From Jan 2021 onward

RISK ASSESSMENT FLOW

WHISP checks each plot sequentially using four key questions:



WHY EACH OUTCOME

LOW: No trees means nothing to protect. Pre-2021 disturbance is outside the EUDR cutoff.

HIGH: Trees existed in 2020, with no prior agriculture or disturbance, followed by post-2020 forest loss.

MORE INFO: No disturbance is detected, but maps cannot distinguish agroforestry from intact forest.

LOW RISK

No tree cover in 2020

If no tree-cover dataset detects trees on the plot at the end of 2020, WHISP immediately classifies it as low risk. Reason: no forest means nothing could have been deforested.

NO trees | NO forest

Trees present, but commodity land already existed in 2020

Tree cover is detected, but commodity datasets also identify agricultural or plantation use at the end of 2020. The commodity predates the EUDR cutoff of 31 Dec 2020, so this is not new deforestation.

Trees | Commodity in 2020

Trees present, no commodity, but disturbance occurred before 2021

Trees are present and no commodity is detected, but disturbance datasets record deforestation or degradation before 1 Jan 2021. This predates the EUDR cutoff and is outside the regulation's scope.

Trees | NO commodity | Disturbance by 2020

HIGH RISK

All of the following conditions must be met:



Tree cover detected at the end of 2020

At least one tree dataset is positive



No commodity or agricultural use in 2020

All commodity datasets are negative



No forest disturbance before 2021

No pre-cutoff deforestation is detected



Forest disturbance detected after 2020

At least one alert dataset is positive after Jan 2021

IMPLICATIONS

The plot is suspected of having experienced deforestation after 31 December 2020, the cutoff date under the EU Deforestation Regulation (EUDR).

Commodities produced from this plot may fail EUDR due-diligence requirements.

MORE INFORMATION NEEDED

Trigger condition: Trees in 2020 | No commodity in 2020 | No disturbance before or after 2020

Why does this result appear?

The plot shows tree cover in 2020, with no commodity signal and no disturbance signal either before or after 2020. Technically, every indicator appears clean.

However, the result is ambiguous because satellite maps cannot distinguish between intact natural forest and an agroforestry system such as cocoa or coffee grown under a tree canopy.

In agroforestry systems, shade trees remain, so no disturbance signal appears. Commodity datasets may also miss the farm because tree cover is still dominant.

NEXT STEPS

Common examples

- Shade-grown cocoa
- Agroforestry coffee
- Tree plantations that resemble natural forest

Recommended verification

- Field visit
- Very-high-resolution satellite imagery
- Land-right documents
- Farmer and supply-chain interviews

Not necessarily safe or dangerous - additional evidence is required.

RISK CLASSIFICATION SUMMARY

Status	Main condition	Reason	Action
LOW RISK	No trees, OR commodity/agriculture already existed in 2020, OR disturbance occurred before 2021.	No indication of an EUDR cutoff violation.	Continue the supply-chain process.
HIGH RISK	Trees in 2020 + no commodity + no earlier disturbance + disturbance detected after 2020.	Clear post-cutoff deforestation signal.	Investigate fully; due diligence is required.
MORE INFO	Trees in 2020 + no commodity + no disturbance before or after 2020.	Data cannot distinguish natural forest from agroforestry.	Use field checks, high-resolution imagery, and land records.